46 Stories in Classical Greek

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More Attic Greek readings, from the supplementary text to Anne H. Groton's *From Alpha to Omega*. Translated as part of homework for GREEK 101 with Prof. Olga Levaniouk at the University of Washington.

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Chapter 5: An Unproductive Business Plan

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 58

Δέσποινα ὄρνῖν ἔχει. ἡ ὄρνῖς ἅπαξ τῆς ἡμέρᾱς ᾠὸν τίκτει. ἐπειδὴ ἡ δέσποινα σπεύδει πλείονα ᾠὰ ἔχειν, κελεύει τὰς θεραπαίνᾱς τῇ ὄρνῑθι πλείονα τροφὴν βάλλειν. καὶ τῇ ὄρνῑθι κελεύει, "Ορᾱ πλείονα ᾠὰ τίκτειν. δὶς τῆς ἡμέρᾱς, ὦ ὄρνῑ, τίκτε ᾠόν.

ἐπεὶ αἱ θεράπαιναι τῆς δεσποίνης ἀκούουσιν, ἐκ τῶν κλῑνῶν σπεύδουσι καὶ τῇ ὄρνῑθι πλείονα τροφὴν βάλλουσιν. τὴν ὄρνῑν ἡ τροφὴ βλάπτει· οὐδ΄ ἅπαξ τῆς ἡμέρᾱς ᾠὰ τίκτει.

ἐπεὶ σπεύδεις, ὦ δέσποινα, ᾠὰ ἔχειν, τὴν ὄρνῑν μὴ βλάπτε.

The mistress possesses a hen. During the day, the hen lays an egg. Since the mistress hastens to possess more eggs, she orders the servants to throw more chicken feed to the hen. And she orders the hen, "It is time to lay more eggs. Lay eggs twice during the day, hen."

When the servants hear the mistress, they hasten out of their beds and throw more chicken feed to the hen. The chicken feed harms the hen; not even once does it lay eggs during the day.

When you are eager, mistress, to possess eggs, do not harm the hen.

Chapter 6: How to Avoid a Beastly Wedding

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 145

Λέων κόρην γαμεῖν σπεύδει. ὁ πατὴρ οὐκ ἐθέλει τὸν γάμον ποιεῖν, ἀλλὰ προσποιεῖται. Ἐθέλω, ὦ λέον, ἀλλ΄ ὀδόντας καὶ ὄνυχας ἔχεις· τὴν κόρην βλάψουσιν. μέλλεις τὴν φύσιν ἀλλάξειν·

ἐπεὶ ὁ λέων ἀκούει, τοὺς ὀδόντας καὶ ὄνυχας ἐκβάλλει καὶ πάλιν εἰς τὴν οἰκίᾱν σπεύδει. ἀλλ΄ ὁ πατὴρ τὸν λέοντα πλήττει καὶ ἐκ τῆς οἰκίᾱς διώκει. Φόβον μὴ ἔχε, ὦ κόρη· βλάπτειν ὁ λέων οὐκέτι ἔχει. φιλαίτερον νυμφίον ἡ Μοῖρα πέμψει.

φύλαττε τὴν φύσιν· εἰ ἐχθρὸς κελεύσει ἀλλάττειν, μὴ ἄχουε.

A lion wishes to marry a girl. The father does not wish to make the wedding, but he pretends. "I am willing, lion, but you have teeth and claws; they will harm the girl. Do you intend to change your nature?"

When the lion hears this, he gets rid of his teeth and claws and hastens again into the house. But the father strikes the lion and chases him out of the house. "Have to fear, girl; the lion is no longer able to harm you. Fate will send a dearer groom."

Guard your nature; if your enemy shall order you to change, do not hear.

Chapter 7: The Donkey Gets Some Horse Sense

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 272

᾽Ανθρωπος ἔχει ἵππον καὶ ὄνον. λέγει ὁ ὄνος τῷ ἵππῳ· Λύπᾱς ἐν τῷ βιῷ ἔχω. ἀλλ΄ ἔχεις χαράς. τοῖς ἵπποις ἡσυχίᾱν πέμπουσιν οἱ θεοί, ἀλλὰ τοὺς ὄνους ἐθέλουσι βλάπτειν. χαῖρε, ὦ ἵππε, τῇ μοίρᾳ.

A man has both a horse and a donkey. The donkey says to the horse, "I have grief in life, but you have joy. The gods send peace to horses, but they wish to harm donkeys. Take joy, horse, in fate."

ἀλλ΄ ἐπεὶ ὁ ἄνθρωπος τὸν ἵππον εἰς τὸν πόλεμον λαμβάνει, λύπᾱς καὶ ἐν ταῖς ὁδοῖς καὶ ἐν τοῖς ποταμοῖς ὁ ἵππος ἔχει. οἱ θεοὶ τὸν ἵππον οὐ φυλάττουσι· πολέμοι τὸν ἄνθρωπον δίωκουσι καὶ τὸν ἵππον λύουσιν. ἐπειδὴ ὁ ὄνος ἀκούει, τὸν ἵππου βίον ἔχειν οὐκέτι σπεύδει.

But when the man takes the horse into war, the horse has griefs both in the roads and in the rivers. The gods did not protect the horse; enemies chase the man and kill the horse. When the donkey hears this, he no longer hastens to have the life of a horse.

τῶν ἀδελφῶν, ὦ ἄνθρωποι, φθόνον μὴ ἔχετε.

Do not have envy of your brothers, men.

Chapter 8: Taking Things Too Literally

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 163

Λύκος λῑμὸν ἔχει καὶ ἐθέλει δεῖπνον εὑρίσκειν. εἰς οἰκίᾱν σπεύδει καὶ τέκνου τὰς βοὰς ἀκούει. ἐν τῇ οἰκίᾳ λεγει θεράπαινα· Μὴ κλᾶε, ὦ τέκνον, ἢ σὲ πέμψω τῷ λύκῳ. τοῖς λόγοις χαίρει ὁ λύκος· Ἡ θεράπαινα τὸ τέκνον πέμψειν μέλλει. ἐπεὶ τὸ τέκνον πάλιν κλᾱήσει, δεῖπνον καλὸν σχήσω.

ὁ λύκος πολλὴν ὥρᾱν μένει. τῆς ἑσπέρᾱς ἀκούει πάλιν τοῦ τέκνου τὰς βοάς. ἀλλ΄ ἡ ἀγαθὴ θεράπαινα τὸ τέκνον οὐ πέμπει τῷ λύκῳ. λέγει, Μὴ ἔχε φόβον, ὦ καλὸν τέκνον· τὸν βίον φυλάξομεν. εἰ ὁ λύκος εἰς τὴν οἰκίᾱν σπεύδει, φονεύσομεν. ὁ λύκος λύπην ἔχει καὶ λέγει, Ἡ θεράπαινα τοῖς λόγοις ὅμοια τὰ ἔργα οὐκ ἔχει. ἀπολείψω τὴν οἰκίᾱν.

πολλοὶ ἄνθρωποι ἄλλα λέγουσιν, ἄλλα πράττουσιν.

A wolf has hunger and wishes to find dinner. He hastens into a house and hears the cries of a child. The servant says in the house: "Don't cry, child, or i shall send you to a wolf." The wolf rejoices at these words: "The servant intends to send [me] the child. Since the child shall cry again, I shall have a good meal."

The wolf waits a long time. During evening he again hears the cry of the child. But the good servant does not send the child to the wolf. She says "Have no fear, good child, we shall guard your life. if a wolf hastens into the house, we shall kill [it]." The wolf has grief and says, "The servant does not have deeds similar to her words. I shall abandon the house."

Many men say some things, but do other things.

Chapter 9: And the Beat Goes On

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 173

Αγύρταις ὄνος δουλεύει καὶ τὰ τύπαωα φέρει. ἐπεὶ ὁ ὄνος ἐν τῇ ὁδῷ μέλλει καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλει σπεύδειν, οἱ ἀγύρται τὸν ὄνον πλήττουσιν. ὁ ὄνος, ἐπειδὴ οἱ ἀγύρται πολλάκις βλάπτουσι, τὸν βίον ἀπολείπει. ἀλλ΄ ἐκ τοῦ δέρματος τοῦ ὄνου καλὰ τύμπανα οἱ ἀγύρται ποιοῦσιν.

ἄλλοι ἀγύρται τοὺς ἀγύρτᾶς βλέπτουσιν ἐν τῇ ὁδῷ· Χαίρετε, ὦ ἀδελφοί. τὸν ὄνον ἔτι ἔχετε· καὶ οἱ πρότεροι δεσπόται τοῦ ὄνου λέγουσιν. Ὁ κακὸς ὄνος ἔτι ἄξιος πληγῶν. οὐκέτι βίον ἔχει, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἔτι πλήττομεν.

ἀκούετε, ὦ μαθηταὶ, καὶ εὑρίσκετε τὴν σοφίᾶν. οἱ οἰκέται καὶ ἐν τῷ θανάτῳ τὴν μοῖραν φεύγειν οὐκ ἔχουσιν· ἐλεύθεροι τῶν ἐν τῷ βίῳ ἔργων, ὅμως ἄλλοις ἔτι δουλεύουσιν.

A donkey serves mendicant priests [lit. beggars] and carries the tambourines. When the donkey hesitates and does not wish to hasten in the journey, the mendicant priests beat the donkey. The donkey, when since the priests harm him often, dies [lit. leaves life]. But from the skin of the donkey the priests make beautiful tambourines.

Other priests see these priests in the journey. "Hello, brothers. Do you still have the donkey?" And the former masters of the donkey say, "An evil donkey still worthy of beatings. he no longer has life, but we beat him still."

Listen, students, and discover wisdom. The servants are not able to flee neither in death nor fate: Free from work in life, nevertheless they still serve others.

Chapter 10: Birdbrained Behavior

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 39

Χελῑδὼν ἐν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ τῶν ὀρνίθων ἔλεγεν· Ἀκούετε μέν, μὴ μέλλετε δὲ πράττειν. οἱ ἄνθρωποι τοὺς ὄρνῑθας διώκειν καὶ λύειν ἔχουσιν. ὥρᾱ οὖν εἰς τοὺς ἀνθρώπους σπεύδειν καὶ περὶ τῆς εἰρήνης λέγειν. εἰ τοὺς ὄρνῑθας τοῖς ἀνθρώποις φίλους ποιήσομεν, τὸν βίον τῶν ὀρνίθων φυλάξομεν.

ἡ χελῑδὼν τὴν ἀλήθειαν ἔλεγεν, ἀλλ᾽ οἱ ὄρνῑθες οὐκ ἤκουον· οἱ μὲν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις λέγειν οὐκ ἠθελον, οἱ δὲ τὸν κίνδῡνον οὐκ ἔβλεπον. ἡ μὲν οὖν φίλη χελῑδὼν νῦν ἐν ταῖς τῶν ἀνθρώπων οἰκίαις τὴν νεοττιὰν ποιεῖ, οἱ δ᾽ ἄλλοι ὄρνῑθες, ἐπεὶ οἱ ἄνθρωποι διώκουσι, θάνατον ἐν τοῖς δικτύοις εὑρίσκουσιν.

φεύγετε, ὦ ἄνθρωποι, τοὺς κινδύνους καὶ τῇ εἰρήνῃ χαίρετε. ἕξετε δ᾽ οὖν βίον ἐλεύθερον κακῶν.

A swallow in the assembly of birds was saying: "You listen, but you do not intend to do. THe men are able to chase and kill birds. It is time, therefore, to hasten into the men and to speak concerning peace. If we make the birds friends to men, we shall guard the life of birds."

The swallow was saying the truth, but the birds were not listening: they were not willing to speak to the men, and they were not seeing the danger. Now, therefore, the friendly swallow makes a nest in the houses of men, while the other birds, since the men chase [them], find death in the nets.

Flee, men, the dangers and cherish peace. Then you shall possess life free from evils.